THE MIGHTY VALKYRIES

MARVEL

2

LGY#16

AARON
GRØNBEKK
DE IULIS
D'URSO
MENYZ



After the Valkyries—Asgardian warriors charged with ferrying the souls of the dead to their eternal reward—were all killed in the War of the Realms, Doctor Jane Foster took up Undrjarn, the All-Weapon, and became the last known Valkyrie.

But there was actually another Valkyrie out there—one lost to time and tragedy. After freeing this ancient warrior and helping her reclaim her legendary weapon—the ax Jarnbjorn—Jane returned to Midgard, while her newfound ally set out to rediscover her own name and past, lost in millennia of imprisonment.

It took the voice of an Oracle to resurrect that name: Rúna. But the Oracle is under lock and key...and Rúna is about to break down the door.

And on Midgard, a shape-shifting wolf roams the streets of Manhattan. Loki claims the creature—the children of Fenris—is hunting the gods. But the shape-shifter, who calls themselves "More," swears they have a different agenda...

THE MIGHTY VALKYRIES

JANE STORY

WRITERS: Jason Aaron & Torunn Grønbekk
ARTIST: Mattia De Iulis

RÚNA STORY

WRITER: Torunn Grønbekk
ARTIST: Erica D'Urso
COLOR ARTIST: Marcio Menyz

LETTERER & PRODUCTION:
VC's Joe Sabino

COVER ARTIST:
Mattia De Iulis

VARIANT COVER ARTIST:
peach Momoko

LOGO:
Jay Bowen

EDITORS:
Wil Moss & Sarah Brunstad

EDITOR IN CHIEF:
C.B. Cebulski

HEL. A FEW WEEKS AGO.

HEL IS NOT WHAT PEOPLE EXPECT. IT IS WHAT THEY DESERVE.

THIS MEANS THAT FOR MOST, IT IS RATHER MUNDANE.

(AND AS AFTERLIVES GO, YOU CAN DO A LOT WORSE THAN MUNDANE.)

HEL IS AN ECHO OF WHAT HAS BEEN. THERE IS NO DISCOVERY HERE. NOTHING BEGINS, AND NOTHING ENDS.

WHATEVER WAS, IS.

WITH HER WIFE, HELA, TRAVELING, KARNILLA IS THE SOLE QUEEN OF THIS CURIOUS REALM. A REALM THAT MORPHS AND CHANGES AT HER WILL, YET REMAINS, IN ESSENCE, THE SAME--A PLACE FOR THE DEAD.

AND THOUGH SHE KNOWS THAT IT IS FUTILE TO LOOK FOR LIFE IN THE AFTER...

...THAT IS WHAT SHE IS DOING.

THERE'S MY BOY!

DADA!

IT IS IMPOSSIBLE NOT TO CONTEMPLATE YOUR OWN LIFE WHILE WALKING THROUGH THE ETERNITIES OF OTHERS.

AND ON HER DARKEST DAYS, KARNILLA FINDS HERSELF WONDERING WHO WOULD WAIT FOR HER WHEN HER TIME COMES.

IT WAS LOVE THAT LED HER TO THIS ROLE.

IT WAS HER CHOICE.

AND NOW SHE IS ABOUT TO MAKE ANOTHER.

THE LONG-BARREN
"CRADLE OF LIFE."

YOU'RE BACK AGAIN, I SEE. HAVE YOU MADE A DECISION?

A CHOICE THAT WILL RELEASE ANOTHER LIVING CREATURE THAT HAS BEEN TRAPPED HERE IN THE REALM OF THE DEAD.

DO IT.

YOU FIRST.

AS SHE REACHES TO UNDO THE LOCK AROUND THEIR NECK, KARNILLA IS TEMPTED TO ASK FOR REASSURANCE.

ASK THIS CREATURE THAT CALLS ITSELF **MORE** TO PROMISE HER SHE WILL NOT REGRET THIS.

BUT THE BARGAIN HAS BEEN MADE--MORE'S FREEDOM FOR THE **WATERS OF URDARBRUNNR.**

HWWK

SHE DOES NOT KNOW IF IT IS THE RIGHT CHOICE.

MOO

BUT WHAT IS LIFE WITHOUT RISK?

THE SACRED WATER REVIVES THE GROUND.

WHAT ARE YOU GOING TO DO NOW?

THE SAME AS YOU, I SUPPOSE.

LIVE.

AND JUST LIKE THAT, LIFE POURS INTO HEL.

NEW YORK. NOW.

JANE FOSTER. JANEY? NO...THAT WAS WHAT YOUR AUNT CALLED YOU.

YOU USED TO HATE IT.

YOU LIKE TULIPS. AND BATH BOMBS.

FRESHLY LAUNDERED PAJAMAS. THE SCENT OF HAREBELL IN VALHALLA.

LIGHT PLEASURES. THERE ARE DARKER ONES AS WELL.

WHAT ARE YOU DOING?!

SO MUCH SACRIFICE.

IT'S THE EASY WAY OUT.

YOU LIKE TO WAIT UNTIL YOUR ICE CREAM IS SOFT. LIKE...A MILKSHAKE.

SO MANY BATTLES. IN HOSPITALS, IN THE SKY.

YOU LIKE IT--THE FIGHTS. YOU CRAVE THEM.

LOVED.

BUT NOT ENOUGH.

WORTHY.

ANGRY.

DOCTOR.

VALKYRIE.

ARE YOU...ARE YOU READING MY MIND?!

I JUST WANT TO GET TO KNOW YOU.

STOP IT!

WHY?

I DON'T KNOW WHAT THIS IS.

IT'S INVASIVE AND PRIVATE AND, FRANKLY, QUITE RUDE.

I'M...I'M SORRY. I DIDN'T KNOW IT WAS BAD.

IT'S JUST... YOU'RE LIKE US. THE MĀNAGARMR. THE MOON HOUNDS. THERE'S ***DUALITY*** IN YOU.

LOKI IS MANY THINGS, BUT STUPID ISN'T ONE OF THEM.

CARELESS.

INFURIATING. THEATRICAL. OVERBEARING.

I AM NOTHING LIKE YOU.

HOW WOULD YOU KNOW?

TOO CURIOUS FOR HIS OWN BOR-DAMNED GOOD.

HEY!

GET BACK HERE!

BUT NOT STUPID.

SO AN ENEMY OF LOKI'S ISN'T NECESSARILY MY FRIEND.

HE WANTED THIS CREATURE CHAINED UP.

HOW WOULD I KNOW?

BUT WHATEVER ANGER MORE BROUGHT WITH THEM LEFT WITH THE GOD OF MISCHIEF.

UNF!

AND ALL THAT REMAINS NOW IS JOY.

EN GARDE!

WELL, FOR ONE, I DON'T KILL PEOPLE.

IS THIS ABOUT LOKI AGAIN? I TOLD YOU... I WAS ONLY GOING TO...

MAIM HIM A BIT--YEAH, I REMEMBER.

DO YOU WORK FOR HIM?

NO. BUT I'M A VALKYRIE, AND WE ARE BOUND TO PROTECT THE GODS. EVEN THE ONES WE DON'T MUCH CARE FOR. IF YOU'RE A THREAT TO THEM--

IF I'M SUCH A THREAT, WHERE ARE THE OTHERS? THE HORDE? THE ARMY OF VALKYRIES?

THEY'RE ALL DEAD.

no...

"ALL EXCEPT ONE."

AHH!

THE PLANET OF PERDITA, IN THE TEMPLE OF THE ORACLE.

THERE ARE LESS THAN THREE WEAPONS IN THE UNIVERSE CAPABLE OF BREAKING THE MAGIC SURROUNDING THE ORACLE.

FORGED IN THE MOUNTAIN FURNACES OF NIDAVELLIR AND BLESSED BY THE BLOOD OF THE THUNDER GOD...

...JARNBJORN IS ONE OF THEM.

AS THE MAGICAL PROTECTION BREAKS, SO DOES THE DISGUISE THAT HAS HIDDEN THE OLD GOD FOR CENTURIES.

THE UNIVERSE RETURNS TO KVASIR. HE SEES EVERYTHING AND NOTHING.

LIKE BRIGHT LIGHT ENTERING EYES LEFT TOO LONG IN DARKNESS.

FOR A FEW MOMENTS, IT BLINDS HIM.

MOMENTS THEY DO NOT HAVE.

ALL-KNOWING KVASIR--WHERE TO?

CAREFUL! DON'T HIT THE ORACLE!

10,000 RUBLINS TO THE ONE WHO SLAUGHTERS THE WOMAN!

KVASIR! NOW WOULD BE A GOOD TIME TO SPEAK!

BEHIND... US...EGRESS IN... DISGUISE.

20,000 TO THE ONE WHO CATCHES HER ALIVE. WE'LL HAVE OURSELVES AN EXECUTION!

A DOOR?

BEWARE... THE...

...FOX...IN SNOW.

OH, FOR THE LOVE OF BOR'S IRRITATED BOWELS, CAN YOU TONE DOWN THE OBSCURITY?

I CAN FIGHT US OUT OF THIS, BUT IT WOULD HELP IF YOU COULD GIVE ME A PATH!

PREFERABLY ONE THAT DOESN'T INCLUDE IMMINENT DEATH.

FOR US...OR THEM?

THERE IS...DEATH ON EVERY... PATH.

WELL, ONE WHERE THE BADDIES DIE AND WE LIVE!

FOX. I GET IT. CLEVER. NOT VERY HELPFUL!

STOP!

GO LEFT.

WANTED

CLEAR INSTRUCTIONS! THIS IS BETTER!

FOR THE FIRST TIME IN CENTURIES, KVASIR STEPS OUT INTO THE WORLD HE HAS SERVED.

&#$&&%#%&#$%&!

IMPRISONED IN THE TEMPLE, HE HAS ONLY SEEN IT THROUGH HIS MIND'S EYE.

BLUE DOOR.

HE HAS NOT SMELLED ITS RANKNESS OR TASTED ITS METALLIC TASTE IN HIS MOUTH BEFORE NOW.

STAIRS.

DREAMFRESH HAS CONTRIBUTED ANOTHER 10,000 RUBLINS TO THE REWARD! KILL THE WOMAN, GET OUR ORACLE BACK, AND REMEMBER, HEALTHY SKIN IS WEALTHY SKIN!

QUIET...

THERE IS A MAN BEHIND THIS DOOR. HIS NAME IS OLOGEN. HE WILL... KILL US FOR THE MONEY. UNLESS YOU...

ON IT.

GET READY.

OOOOOF!

KRAAACK

+GASP+

THIS PATH IS CLEAR.

WANTED

THE SHIP IS JUST AHEAD.

RUN.

READY FOR IMMEDIATE DEPARTURE. LIFTOFF IN FIVE SECONDS.

HEY! YOU WERE WRONG--NO DEATHS, UNLESS THE SNOWY FOX EXPLODED IN A FIT OF RAGE.

OH, HOW I LOVE ANGRY WOMEN.

THE RADIATION IN THE WATER. THE MAN--OLOGEN--WILL BE DEAD IN HOURS.

AND THE FIGHT...THE FIGHT IS NOT YET OVER.

HALT!

"TELL ME SOMETHING, VALKYRIE..."

...HOW BIG WOULD A PRISON NEED TO BE FOR THE PRISONER TO NO LONGER CRAVE FREEDOM?

WHAT DO YOU MEAN?

I MEAN... IF YOU CLOSED DOWN MANHATTAN. EVERYONE HAD EVERYTHING THEY NEEDED, BUT NO ONE COULD LEAVE. WOULD THEY FEEL TRAPPED?

I DON'T KNOW... *I WOULD*, CERTAINLY.

OKAY, SAY YOUR PRISON WAS AMERICA, THEN. MOST PEOPLE DO NOT LEAVE THE COUNTRY ANYWAY. WOULD YOU FEEL TRAPPED?

LOKI LOCKED ME UP WHEN I WAS JUST A *PUP*. HE COULD HAVE GIVEN ME ROOM TO ROAM, BUT HE CHOSE NOT TO.

CHAINED BY THAT PIECE OF METAL YOU KEEP IN YOUR POCKET. I HAD NOT DONE ANYTHING WRONG, BECAUSE I HAD NOT DONE *ANYTHING*... I WAS CHAINED UP BECAUSE THE GODS WERE SCARED OF WHAT I *MIGHT DO*.

AND THEY MADE SURE I *KNEW*. THEY MADE SURE I KNEW THERE WAS A WORLD OUTSIDE THAT I WAS NOT ALLOWED TO SEE...

TELL ME--IS THAT FAIR?

AND WHEN YOU WERE RELEASED, THE FIRST THING YOU DID WAS KILL.

NO...

"...THAT WAS SOMEONE ELSE."

IF THE LAST SON OF KRAVEN WERE THE SORT OF MAN WHO TALKED OF HIS EMOTIONS, HE WOULD DESCRIBE THIS FEELING AS A MIX OF FEAR, RESPECT, AND ANTICIPATION.

IT IS WHAT THE **OUTRAGED** FAIL TO UNDERSTAND, HE WOULD SAY.

THEY THINK IT IS ABOUT THE KILL. THEY ARE WRONG.

A SOLDIER DISTANCES THEMSELVES FROM THEIR ENEMY. THE AIM IS DESENSITIZATION. HATE. WHATEVER IT TAKES TO PULL THE TRIGGER.

THE HUNTER DOES THE OPPOSITE. THE HUNTER TRIES TO UNDERSTAND THEIR PREY. THEY WANT TO KNOW HOW IT THINKS, WHAT IT LOVES, WHAT IT FEARS.

IT IS WHY THE BEST HUNTERS ARE EMPATHIC.

A GOOD HUNT IS AN ACT OF RESPECT.

I WAS ATTACKED, AND I DEFENDED MYSELF. LIKE ANYONE-- EVERYONE-- WOULD DO.

IT REQUIRES SACRIFICE.

EVERY ONE OF THE PEOPLE DOWN THERE--EVERY SINGLE ONE OF THEM-- HAS A GREAT CAPACITY FOR DESTRUCTION.

THEY COULD KILL THEIR LOVED ONES IN THEIR SLEEP OR TAKE A WEAPON TO A CROWDED PLACE AND WREAK HAVOC. YET THEY DO NOT.

AND ***YOU!*** WHAT ABOUT YOU? THE THINGS YOU COULD DO, IF YOU WANTED.

DO YOU NEED SOMEONE TO TELL YOU WHAT'S RIGHT OR WRONG? A BOOK? A GUIDE? A ***GOD?***

WHY WOULD THE THINGS THAT KEEP ***YOU*** FROM BEING EVIL NOT KEEP ***ME?***

THERE IS DARKNESS IN US ***ALL***, JANE FOSTER. IT DOES NOT MEAN WE WILL LET IT WIN.

IT REQUIRES PLANNING.

I JUST WANT TO *LIVE*. MAYBE TASTE THE THINGS YOU LOVE, LIKE THIS ICED, SHAKED MILK.

WILL YOU JOIN M--

I GOT THY ALL-WEAPON SIGNAL, VALKYRIE.

IT REQUIRES TIMING.

ROAR!

MORE, NO! HE'S A FRIEND!

A GOOD HUNT IS POETRY.

IT IS ART.

EH...?

SLICE

THIS THY IDEA OF A NIGHT OUT, VALKYRIE? THA GOT DOLLED UP AN' EVERYTHIN'? A FORTNIGHT SELECTIN' FOOTWEAR ALONE?

ARE YOU DONE?

AYE... WOLF OR THE LION LAD?

LION LAD!

A GOOD HUNT IS ABOUT PLANNING FOR THE UNEXPECTED.

TINK

THREE SECONDS, GERLA.

ONE MISSISSIPPI...


GROWL


OH MY GOD!


BOOM


...THREE MISSISSIPPI.


...TWO MISSISSIPPI...

AND IN THE END...

...THE BEST PART IS NOT THE KILL.

KRRSHLNK

OWWOOOOO

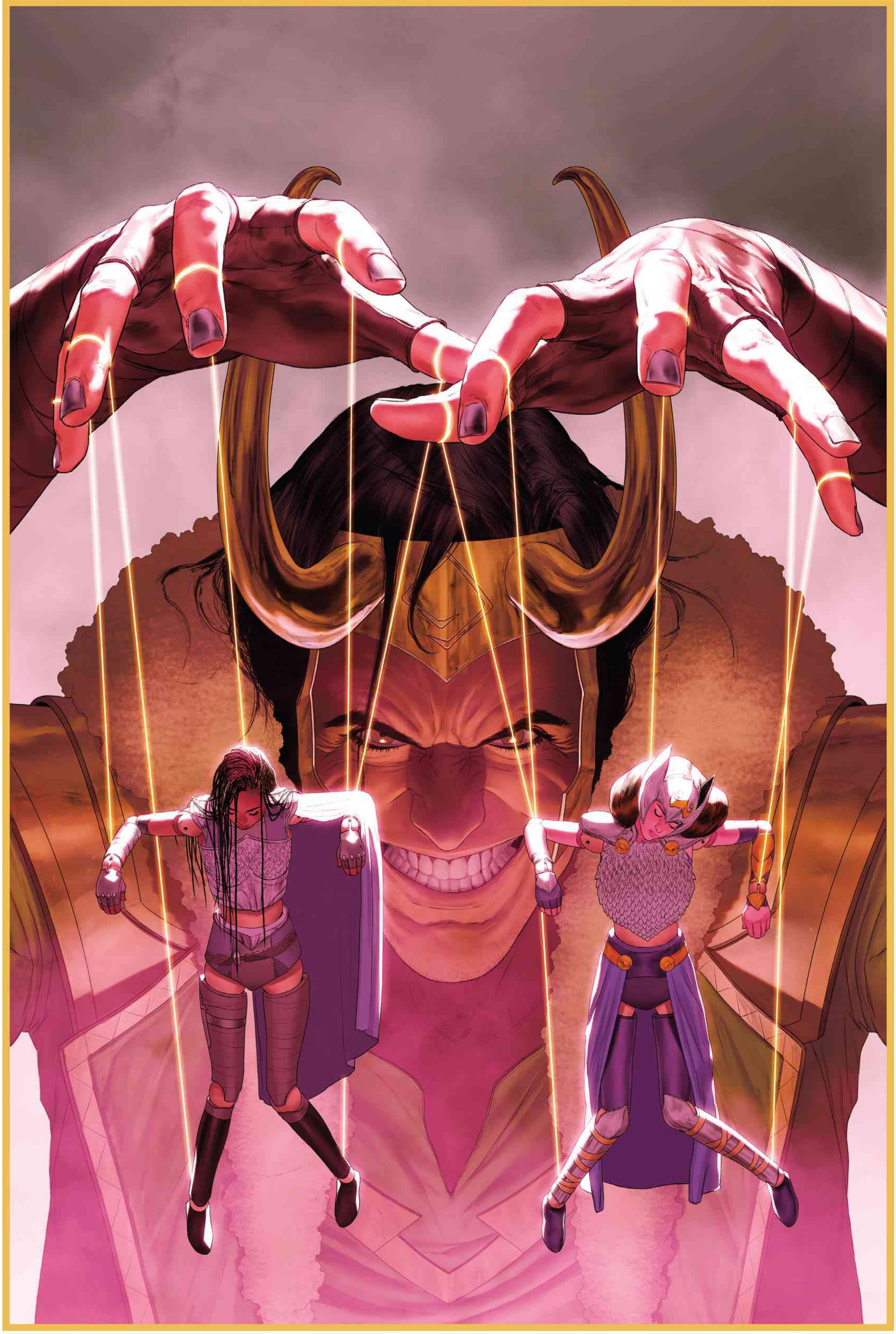
IT IS THE SHARED UNDERSTANDING BETWEEN YOU AND YOUR PREY.

THAT IT WAS A FIGHT WELL FOUGHT--

--AND FAIRLY WON.

TO BE CONTINUED!

NEXT MONTH:



© 2021 MARVEL. No similarity between any of the names, characters, persons, and/or institutions in this magazine with those of any living or dead person or institution is intended, and any such similarity which may exist is purely coincidental.

@marvelcomicpdf

MY NAME IS JEAN GREY.

NOW...